



Leader of the pack: The Swede brought the roof down at the Stade de France, as he set a new world record of 6.25m. AFP

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POLE VAULT

THE NIGHT MONDO FULFILLED HIS CHILDHOOD FANTASY

It's hard not to marvel at how fitting his nickname Mondo was in this record-breaking moment. As the words *Record du Monde* (French for 'world record') lit up the stadium's big screen, Armand Duplantis' **achievement felt almost destined.**

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Armand 'Mondo' Duplantis would later say he had been preparing for this moment all his life. "Back when I was just a kid jumping in my backyard in Louisiana, I'd think about this all the time. I'd imagine I was jumping for an Olympic gold and also the world record," he said.